The Support to State Extension Programmes for Extension Reforms Scheme was launched in 2005-06, aiming at making the extension system farmer driven as well as accountable to farmers by providing for new institutional arrangements for technology dissemination. This has been done through setting up of Agricultural Technology Management Agencies (ATMA) at district level to operationalise the extension reforms. The ATMA has active participation of farmers/farmer groups, nongovernment organisations (NGOs) and other stakeholders operating at district level and below. Gender concerns are being mainstreamed by mandating that 30 per cent of resources on programmes and activities are utilised by women farmers and women extension functionaries.

Certain **other schemes**[53] which support agriculture sector are:

- ***Mass media support*** to agriculture focusing on Doordarshan infrastructure and All India Radio (AIR) broadcasting agriculture-related information;
- ***Kisan Call Centres*** (KCC) to provide agricultural information to the farming community through toll free telephone lines;
- ***Agri-clinic*** and ***agribusiness*** centres by agriculture graduates to provide extension services to farmers on payment basis through setting up of economically viable self–employment ventures, and information dissemination through agri fairs;
- ***Extension education institutes*** at *Nilokher* (Haryana), *Rajendra Nagar* (Andhra Pradesh), *Anand* (Gujarat), and *Jorhat* (Assam) are operating at regional level to improve the skills and professional competence of extension field functionaries of agriculture and allied departments;
- There are ***model training courses*** on thrust areas of agriculture, horticulture, animal husbandry, and fisheries with the objective of improving the professional competence, upgrading the knowledge, and developing technical skills of subject matter specialists/extension workers of agriculture and allied departments; and
- ***MANAGE,*** Hyderabad, an apex Institute at the national level, provides training to middle and senior level officers of agriculture